our belief that the world is and has to be many-hued. It is an assertion of our own right to look at the world the way we see it. We do not think there is one and only one infallible path which all must follow. Independence is the core of the logic of non-alignment.'[106] Forty years after Independence, Indian leaders still sought to follow an independent foreign policy, and non-alignment continued to be seen as the way to maintain independence.

For Rajiv, as for his predecessors, non-alignment reflected India's fervent desire for independence as well as its quest for international peace.[107] Like Nehru and Indira, Rajiv saw non-alignment as the 'alternative' to military alliances and the pursuit of balance of power. [108] Speaking on the occasion of the twenty-fifth anniversary of the NAM in Harare, Rajiv echoed Nehru when he referred to non-alignment as 'an idea, a reality, a movement' and a major force 'that transformed history'.[109] Like Nehru and Indira, Rajiv emphasized the need for 'peaceful coexistence' instead of a 'vain and dangerous pursuit of confrontation and domination'. [110]

The membership of the Non-Aligned Movement had risen from twenty-two members in 1961 to around 100 in 1986. Even countries that previously belonged to one of the two cold war blocs now embraced non-alignment as, in Rajiv's words, the 'way out of the impasse in which conventional politics and civilization find themselves'. Rajiv asserted that India and its fellow non-aligned friends had not only 'withstood' the pressure of the blocs but also 'kept faith' in their principles. According to Rajiv, independence and non-alignment should be seen as the 'driving forces' behind India's domestic and foreign policies. This would boost India's economic strength that in turn would help India obtain respect.[111]

For Rajiv, non-alignment was not simply about uniting developing countries. It was a path towards economic cooperation and multilateralism. 'Complementarities of Southern countries offer possibilities of fruitful economic cooperation: resources in raw materials, manufacturing capacity, finance and credit, managerial and production skills and range of matching